



The Digital World

A Round-up Of Technology News From Across The Globe

UNITED STATES

San Francisco hopes to have a city-wide Wi-Fi system up and running before September. Libraries, retail stores and hotels throughout the city provide Wi-Fi to patrons, but cyber-café make up the majority of the city's hotspots

ISRAEL

National Internet Safety Day was celebrated on March 9. The Day is aimed at raising awareness about the dangers of the Internet and how one can avoid them. Thousands of parents participated in the event, which highlighted the dangers the Internet posed to children

CHINA

US tech companies eyeing China face a dilemma: while keen to tap a market that could soon eclipse America's, they must also worry about the perception that they're helping China harass dissidents. US companies must satisfy a government that fiercely polices Internet content

JAPAN

Older customers have found the Nintendo DS user-friendly. The latest titles let players study English, raise a virtual puppy, or converse with animals in an imaginary village



NIGERIA

Africa is turning into a digital dump. Recycled computers have the potential to help bridge the digital divide. African countries are a robust market for such equipment. But experts in Lagos say as much as 75 per cent are "junk," which is accumulated or burnt in dump sites



AUSTRALIA

Australian Internet users are crawling along the Internet compared with other developed nations. Per head of population, Australia's broadband Internet speed was just over 1 Mbps. This compares to Britain (13 Mbps), France (8.4 Mbps), Germany (6.85 Mbps) Canada (6.8 Mbps) and the US (3.3 Mbps)

the researchers built a system with a weakness and then proceeded to show how the weakness could be exploited. "(It's not surprising that) poor system design, whether capturing RFID tag information, bar code information or keyboard-entered data, will create vulnerabilities," he said.

We must stress that the findings by the Dutch researchers are under the microscope. This may turn out to be just another research paper, and this piece of news might just be forgotten a few months from now. But we'll have to wait and watch.

VERSUS MICROSOFT

Google Adds Online Word Processor

As part from the fact that Microsoft has revved up its search engine, the latest in the Google vs. Microsoft saga is that the former has added another tool to its

growing online-services repertoire with the purchase of Upstartle, a Silicon Valley startup that makes an application called Writely.

Writely is basically a word processor embedded into a Web browser. It's still in beta form. The Writely application lets users compose and edit documents online. Amongst the formats supported by Writely are Word, OpenOffice, HTML, and plaintext. One can view a document's revision history and roll back to earlier iterations. In addition to basic document-creation features, Writely gives users the ability to collaborate online—one can grant access to a document by adding people to the document's list of contributors; one can also publish to most of the popular blogging sites. Visit www.writely.com for more details.

Writely beta was launched in August 2005 and is "far from perfect," according to a blog posting by Jen Mazzon, formerly of Upstartle and now a



Three Incredibly Useful Sites

IM, Radio, Career Skills

meebo



www.35.meebo.com

Meebo is where you should head for if you don't have any popular messengers installed on your system and still wish to chat. Yahoo!, Hotmail, or AIM—this site allows you to chat freely from within your browser. You can chat even if IM ports have been blocked! Messages are transmitted from port 80, which cannot be easily restricted.

MindTools



www.mindtools.com

"The Internet's Most Visited Career Skills Resource," the site calls itself. Here, you can learn the practical skills needed to excel in your career. The site covers the most common skills—from time and stress management, information skills, memory improvement, problem solving and decision making to creativity and more. All these sections are covered in-depth, with practical examples.

LIVE365.COM



www.live365.com

If you're a music buff with a broadband connection, here's a Web site you must tune into! There are thousands of Internet radio stations listed here with different bitrates to suit your connection. Tune into stations based on genre, search for music, and listen to Podcasts. Access costs \$9.95 (Rs 440) per month, but it could be worth it.